COMPUTERS

HARDWARE

Internal Components

These are the parts located inside the computer case that do the processing and storage.

- **Central Processing Unit (CPU)**: The "brain" of the computer that executes instructions and processes data.
- **Motherboard**: The main circuit board that connects all the individual components together.
- **Random Access Memory (RAM)**: The temporary, high-speed memory used to run open applications and tasks.
- **Solid-State Drive (SSD)**: Modern, ultra-fast storage that permanently saves files, games, and the operating system.
- **Hard Disk Drive (HDD)**: Traditional, mechanical storage used mainly for large-capacity file archives.
- **Graphics Processing Unit (GPU)**: Also called the **Video Card**, it renders images, videos, and 3D graphics for gaming or editing.
- **Power Supply Unit (PSU)**: Converts electrical power from the wall outlet into usable energy for the internal parts.
- **Cooling System**: Uses fans (air cooling) or liquid loops (liquid cooling) to prevent the CPU and GPU from overheating.

Peripheral Devices

These are the external hardware parts that connect to the computer to input or output data.

- **Input Devices**: Tools used to send data to the computer (e.g., **Keyboard**, **Mouse**, **Microphone**, **Webcam**).

© **Università degli Studi eCampus** - Via Isimbardi 10 - 22060 Novedrate (Co) - C.F. 9002752130 - Tel: 031.79421 - Fax: 031.7942501 - Mail: info@uniecampus.it

- **Output Devices**: Tools used to show or play data from the computer (e.g., **Monitor / Screen**, **Speakers**, **Headphones**, **Printer**).
- **Storage Devices**: External drives used to move or back up data (e.g., **USB Flash Drive**, **External Hard Drive**).

SOFTWARE

- **Application:** A software program or "app" designed to help users perform specific personal, business, or educational tasks (e.g., web browsers, media players, or games).
- **Word-Processing:** Software used to create, format, edit, and print text-based documents like letters, reports, or resumes. Common examples include Microsoft Word and Google Docs.
- **Spreadsheet:** A digital application that organizes, calculates, and analyses data in rows and columns. Data can include text, numbers, and formulas (e.g., Microsoft Excel or Apple Numbers).
- **Database:** A highly organized, structured collection of data stored electronically so it can be rapidly searched, sorted, and updated (e.g., customer or inventory lists).
- **Computer Graphics:** The branch of computer science and art focused on generating, manipulating, and displaying digital images, animations, and visual content.
- **Virus:** A type of malicious software (malware) that attaches to a host program or file, replicates itself, and spreads to other files or computers. It can damage data or disrupt system performance.
- **Display:** An electronic visual output device (such as a monitor or screen) that shows text, images, and graphics generated by the computer.
- **Cursor:** An indicator on a display device that shows where the next user action—like typing a character or clicking a mouse—will take place. It is usually a blinking line in text or an arrow on your desktop.

© **Università degli Studi eCampus** - Via Isimbardi 10 - 22060 Novedrate (Co) - C.F. 9002752130 - Tel: 031.79421 - Fax: 031.7942501 - Mail: info@uniecampus.it

COMPUTERS

Task 1

Match the words with the definitions.

1. Application
2. Word-processing
3. Spreadsheet
4. Database
5. Computer graphics
6. Virus
7. Display
8. Cursor

A. A malicious program that replicates itself and can damage data.
B. The screen that shows text, images, and visual output.
C. Software used to create, edit, and format text documents.
D. A visual indicator that shows where your next action will happen.
E. A highly structured and organized collection of digital data.
F. A software program designed to help users perform specific tasks.
G. The creation, manipulation, and display of digital images.
H. A grid of rows and columns used to organize data and calculate numbers.

© **Università degli Studi eCampus** - Via Isimbardi 10 - 22060 Novedrate (Co) - C.F. 9002752130 - Tel: 031.79421 - Fax: 031.7942501 - Mail: info@uniecampus.it

Task 2

Fill in the gaps with a suitable word.

1. When you move your mouse, the _____ moves across your screen.
2. WhatsApp is a popular smartphone _____ used for messaging.
3. I need to calculate my monthly budget, so I will open a _____ program like Excel.
4. My computer is lagging and deleting files; I think it has a _____.
5. To write my resume and cover letter, I need to use a _____ tool.

© **Università degli Studi eCampus** - Via Isimbardi 10 - 22060 Novedrate (Co) - C.F. 9002752130 - Tel: 031.79421 - Fax: 031.7942501 - Mail: info@uniecampus.it

KEY

Task 1

1) F
2) C
3) H
4) E
5) G
6) A
7) B
8) D

Task 2

1. cursor
2. application
3. spreadsheet
4. virus
5. word-processing

© **Università degli Studi eCampus** - Via Isimbardi 10 - 22060 Novedrate (Co) - C.F. 9002752130 - Tel: 031.79421 - Fax: 031.7942501 - Mail: info@uniecampus.it

COMPUTERS

Answer the following questions.

1) Do you use a desktop, a laptop or a tablet?
2) Which apps do you use most frequently?
3) How often do you back up your data?
4) Have you ever accidentally deleted anything?
5) If you had to live without a computer, what would you miss the most?

© **Università degli Studi eCampus** - Via Isimbardi 10 - 22060 Novedrate (Co) - C.F. 9002752130 - Tel: 031.79421 - Fax: 031.7942501 - Mail: info@uniecampus.it